cultural activities. This council regularly prepared project reports and offered suggestions, which were then studied carefully by the administrative staff and were later, by and large, implemented.

A series of seminars were held with the prisoners as the main participants. The topics here range from 'Why crime?' to 'Why *Vipassana*?

' 'It is from these seminars,' explained the superintendent, 'that a number of suggestions came to us. This is the workshop where new programmes are forged and because the changes pertain to the participants and because the suggestions also come from them, the new changes are very readily accepted by all.'

The factory in Jail 2 had reached a level of self-sufficiency because of such participation and interaction.

'We were short of looms in our factory,' disclosed Superintendent Tarseem Kumar, 'and we were contemplating buying some from Ludhiana [in Punjab]. But the prisoners suggested that they would make the looms themselves. Now five such looms have already been completed and another five are being made. This has increased our output tremendously. We have started making *khaes* [bed spreads], cotton shawls, cotton dusters, uniform cloth, etc., in this factory. In the carpentry section we have decided to switch over from making bigger items to smaller ones which we have realized are more popular with our customers – items like *chakla belans* [rolling pins], peg tables, children's chairs, small round tables and so on.'

He went on to list some of the other activities and plans: 'In the tailoring section we have undertaken job works for the Khadi Gram Udyog and this has proved most beneficial. In the chemicals factory, we have now started making our own sulphurated soaps which were a long-felt requirement of the prisoners. Our plan now is to open a factory showroom outside the jail premises which would greatly facilitate the sale of our products.'

All the profits, of course, were channelled into the prisoners' welfare fund.

Another inmate, Satendra Kumar, wrote in the monthly magazine *Nav Chetna*, which was published by Central Jail No. 4:

> A Legal Aid Programme was introduced in Central Jail No. 4, Tihar, in the month of July 1993. The aim of the programme is to ensure that all prisoners, who are unable to engage an advocate, who has been visiting this jail and with the help of undertrial prisoners Satendra Kumar and Prit Pal Singh, has been drafting, typing and despatching the applications and other petitions for the prisoners to different courts, can do so.
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> A large number of prisoners have been benefited by the Legal Aid Cell which is provided by the Delhi Legal Aid and Advice Board. Many prisoners have been granted bail by the courts through the petitions filed by this cell. Also, many prisoners were able to file their appeals in the Delhi High Court through this cell. As a result of the petitions filed by the Legal Aid Cell to eliminate delay in trials the honourable Delhi High Court has directed the Delhi Administration to constitute ten more special courts so that the trial of the NDPS Act cases could be conducted speedily. A number of these cases have been transferred from the court of Shri Kuldeep Singh, additional sessions judge (ASJ) Delhi, and now the dates given by the courts are shorter than given earlier. The Legal Aid Cell advocate used to visit this jail three times a week earlier. But now the visiting days have been increased for educating the prisoners about legal matters connected with their cases. With the cooperation of the jail administration the legal service has shown signs of considerable improvement.